

Android Malware: The Troublesome Ten

This article covers the 10 most deadly malware that hit the Android world.



You've received your latest cell phone bill, and it claims that the amount due from you is Rs 5,546—but you have only made a few local calls, sent a few texts off and on, and subscribed to an economically feasible data plan. Even if you give that New Year's Eve party the benefit of doubt, this bill makes no sense, does it? What if I tell you this amount isn't a result of any billing error, and represents your actual usage? How, you might wonder? A valid doubt, but to answer it, let's try a brief flashback.

At the dawn of Christmas day, you rushed to the tree, and were excited to discover that Santa left a present for you. Hurriedly you opened it -- only to find the latest Android phone that you had wished for. In no time, you loaded it with all kinds of apps that you had heard about from your friends, the Internet, and other such sources. All was going well until the day you received that bill. If only you had taken a moment to consider the age-old advice, "Always know what you're getting into," from Kappler Inc, before loading your new phone with all those 'wonderful' apps. One of the apps you loaded was infected

with the malware called *Android.trojan.SMSSend*, which sent premium-rate SMSs to preconfigured numbers, while you were enjoying the benefits of that app.

And the deadliest 10 Android malware are....

So now that I have drawn your attention to this aspect of your Android device, I'd like to provide some insight into what other havoc these malware can create. Here are the top 10 malware that raised hell in the otherwise peaceful life of Android users:

1. **Android.Trojan.SMSSend:** This malware can sneak into your device via advertisements in free apps, fake apps (apps that are rogue, and usually require the user to send a SMS to a premium-rate number for activation, or other similar activity), etc. Once inside your Android device, it sits silently and starts sending SMSs to premium-rate numbers. These premium-rate numbers are either preconfigured in the malware, or are picked up from the command and control centre. It has the capability to launch itself on reboot. It can also access the contacts stored in your device, and send each one